



Lenovo 3000 Y500

Feature-rich, priced just right

This time we got the chance to test the Lenovo model that played the role of *computerji* in the popular quiz show *Kaun Banega Crorepati*.

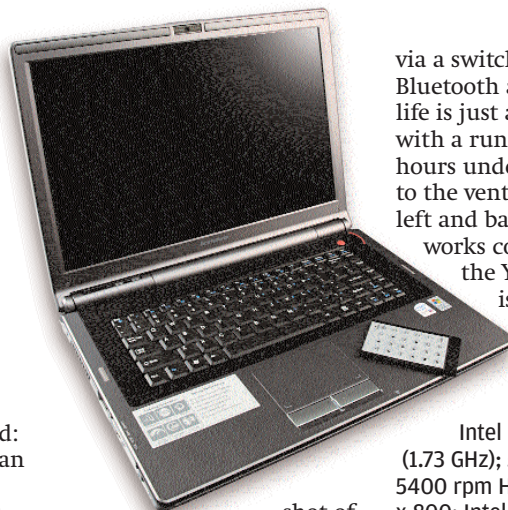
Sporting a silver-metallic finish, the unit is quite sturdy. Weight is 2 kg. Ergonomic keys require light strokes and are placed close together, while the generously-sized touchpad feels smooth to work with, and has ample space for wrist support around it.

The WXGA display provides excellent picture quality; viewability from

wide angles isn't a problem. Powered by a Core Duo processor, it doesn't lack in the performance department either, churning out 38 fps at 1024 x 768 in *Call of Duty*. It encoded our test DVD to AVI video in 182 seconds, which is good.

The feature set is sound: the buttons on the front can be used for battery management, there's a 1.3 megapixel camera on top of the display, and a media centre called "Shuttle Center" which can also be controlled using the bundled remote.

The face verification feature is also quite cool: it can distinguish faces accurately, and scans your face to log you into Windows. It even logs a cam-



shot of the last user who failed the verification process, though it should be noted that the verification process can be bypassed altogether just by closing the window—no real security here.

The Dolby-certified surround sound subsystem situated on the front of the unit can be turned on or off

via a switch; ditto the Bluetooth and Wi-Fi. Battery life is just about average with a running time of 2:33 hours under stress. Thanks to the vents provided on the left and back, the Lenovo works cool. The price of the Y5000—Rs 56,000—is just right, we think, for its configuration.

Specifications

Intel Core Duo T2250 (1.73 GHz); 512 MB RAM; 80 GB 5400 rpm HDD; 15.4-inch 1280 x 800; Intel 945GM chipset; onboard graphics; slot-in DVD-RW; Intel 802.11a/b/g; Bluetooth, 10/100 Ethernet; FireWire; 1.3 MP camera; TV-Tuner, 6c Li-ion batteries; Windows XP Home

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Web site: www.lenovo.com
Price: Rs. 56,000

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Mitashi MPF 1001

Something for St. Valentine's Day

Here's a gift idea for the 14th: the MPF 1001 comes with two headphone jacks! The body is made of jet-black, non-reflective material, which seems to be scratch-resistant.

A 2-colour OLED display provides basic navigational indications, and displays MP3 ID3 tags. OLEDs are more energy-efficient as compared to LCDs, but the low battery life of the player hardly reflects this. The Li-ion battery can be recharged via USB, and Mitashi also provides a 2-pin power adapter.

Button placement is not intuitive. There is a centre button and a button each in the four directions. However, the centre button is just for playback (instead of the usual Select), while

the top "Menu" button is for "Select". The one at the bottom brings up the volume control during playback. The left and right buttons are for moving forward and backward, and also up and down. All the buttons are somewhat hard to press, and are sometimes sluggish or even unresponsive.

The MPF 1001 recognises MP3 and WMA, but we would have liked support for formats such as AAC. Performance-wise, the sound lacks punch: while the treble is passable, the bass is seriously deficient. The bundled earphones don't help either. On top of that, they aren't comfortable, and we can't recommend they be worn for more than a couple of hours.

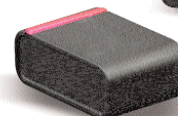
Storage capacity is 1 GB. The device supports two storage modes: Media Class Storage, in which the player is recognised as a removable drive, and Media Transfer Mode, which allows you to sync the device using WMP10 to transfer MP3s to the player.

Despite support for USB 2.0, data transfer is quite slow: it took us two minutes to transfer 100 MB. Other features include a car stereo adapter, FM radio, and voice recording.



Specifications

1 GB; audio formats: MP3, WMA; 2-colour OLED; dual-earphone sockets; earphones; car stereo adapter; USB 2.0



RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Ease of use	★★★☆☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Over all	★★★★☆

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Price: Rs. 3,690